Compartés: growing holiday sales with a clear plan

2026 Meta Agency Award winner: Performance Campaign of the Year by a Boutique Agency in North America. Campaign: November 1–December 31, 2025. My role: paid-media leadership, budget planning, creative direction, AI-assisted work and the award submission. Campaign results belong to the team.



Holiday chocolate gift assortment from the original campaign submission. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Compartés needed to sell more chocolate during its busiest season. The job was to reach more gift buyers, give them a reason to buy and spend more when the sales could support it. We finished the season with $2.84 million in Shopify sales. During Black Friday and Cyber Monday, we nearly doubled Meta spend while lowering the cost of a purchase.

This case shows the work behind those results: my original planning tasks, the budget, the ads, the account decisions and the full results. Read the full campaign submission, inspect the planning excerpts or download the case and evidence as a PDF.

My work, with original planning evidence

I helped lead paid media and owned the award submission. My original work records also show that I created and was assigned the holiday budget plan and the campaign update task. Those records establish a concrete contribution to planning and direction. They do not mean I personally made every ad or carried out every change.

The update task was created on November 5, 2025 and last updated on November 21, before Black Friday. It calls for larger budgets in measured steps, more compilation videos, holiday creator content, photography and stronger promotion of the advent calendar. One instruction reads:

Increase budgets 10-20% WoW

Another calls for a daily check of budget, spend, revenue, marketing efficiency and platform return. That is the work of keeping the team focused: decide what to make, what to watch and how quickly to increase investment. The public excerpt removes people's names and internal links; the private original retains the author and assignment fields.

The budget-plan task was created November 7 and last updated December 15. It contains a $200,000 Meta plan with five stages, built around the previous year's demand pattern. Because that task was edited during the season, I describe it as the recorded operating plan rather than claiming every final note was present on November 7.

My AI use supported this work: creative ideas, copy, research, analysis and tools to help with account decisions. I chose the business questions, directed the work, reviewed the output and helped turn it into action. Creators, designers and other strategists contributed the assets and execution. The award recognizes that shared campaign work.

The business problem

Premium chocolate is a crowded holiday category. Buyers are choosing a gift, comparing prices and trying to get it delivered on time. Compartés has a strong visual advantage: unusual flavors, striking packaging and products that look like a thoughtful gift. The ads had to make those advantages easy to see.

We needed to grow quickly without spending the whole budget too early. We also needed enough useful creative for Meta to find different kinds of buyers. One ad cannot do all of that: a product close-up, a creator explaining a flavor and a clear sale message each give someone a different reason to act.

The operating target was an account-level Meta return above 4x, meaning more than four dollars of attributed purchase value per dollar of ad spend. We checked that alongside store sales and overall advertising cost. Return on ad spend is a revenue measure; it is not profit.

The $200,000 holiday plan

The plan divided the season by how people were likely to shop. Early November was for lighter testing. The weeks before Black Friday built momentum. The heaviest investment went into the sale and the following peak. December focused on gifting, delivery deadlines and then purchases after the holiday.

Stage	Dates in the planning task	Planned Meta budget	Purpose
Early warm-up	November 1–7	$15,000	Keep testing light while early demand is weaker
Before Black Friday	November 8–21	$40,000	Build toward the sale and test creative
Sale and extended peak	November 22–December 8	$85,000	Put the most investment into the strongest demand period
Holiday gifting	December 9–20	$45,000	Support gift purchases before delivery cutoffs
After the holiday	December 21–31	$15,000	Continue where lower competition and self-gifting support sales
Total plan	November–December	$200,000	Five stages with room to adjust daily

These are planned amounts from the task, not actual spend by stage. Its rough percentage notes do not all match the dollar amounts, so the table uses the dollars, which add to $200,000. The $85,000 peak allocation covers a longer window than the nine-day Black Friday results below.

Final Meta spend was $201,210.57, about 0.6% above the plan. The team used 10–20% budget increases and checked performance before the next increase. This gave the team a shared plan without pretending that a holiday account could run on a fixed schedule alone.

Four clear jobs for the campaigns

I wanted the account to be easier to understand and act on. The submission describes four commercial roles: keep proven ads selling, support the sale, let shoppers discover products and launch seasonal items. Each role had a clear reason to exist.

Campaign role	What it did	Reported spend	Meta return
Evergreen	Keep proven sales ads running	$121,805.49	5.29x
Black Friday promotion	Give buyers a clear reason to act during the offer	$25,514.00	4.42x
Shopping and catalog	Show relevant products from the catalog	$22,820.86	3.44x
Seasonal products	Promote limited editions and the advent calendar	$29,064.53	3.17x

These four selected roles total $199,204.88. They leave $2,005.69 of the account total outside this breakdown. The submission does not explain that remainder. Also, the Black Friday campaign row is one campaign role across the season; the nine-day account result includes other campaigns running at the same time.

The account used Meta's Advantage+ Audience for approximately 87% of consumer spend and kept placements open. In plain English: give Meta room to find buyers, then judge the result. First-party inputs, including Shopify audiences, customer segments, purchaser exclusions and selected lookalikes, provided additional guidance.

We kept a place for specific tests too. A household-income and Online Shopping test returned 7.12x. Broad delivery was the core, while separate tests let the team challenge assumptions and see where another approach could work.

Actual creative from the campaign

The images below are reproduced unchanged from the original award submission. They show real campaign assets, not newly made portfolio mockups. Video ads and the GIF appear as still images here. Spend, return and click-through rate are the figures reported for each featured ad in the submission.

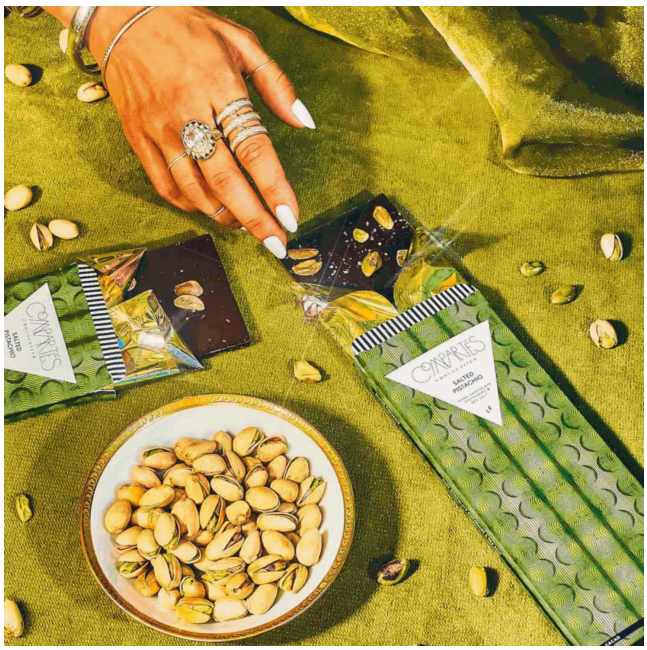
Creator video: show the product in someone's hands



Still from an evergreen creator video holding three Compartés chocolate bars. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Spend: **$13,955.15**. Meta return: **6.15x**. Click-through rate: **0.93%**. This was the submission's highest-spend featured ad. It puts the packaging and product in a person's hands, which makes the size, variety and gift appeal easy to understand. I directed campaign needs; the creator made the video.

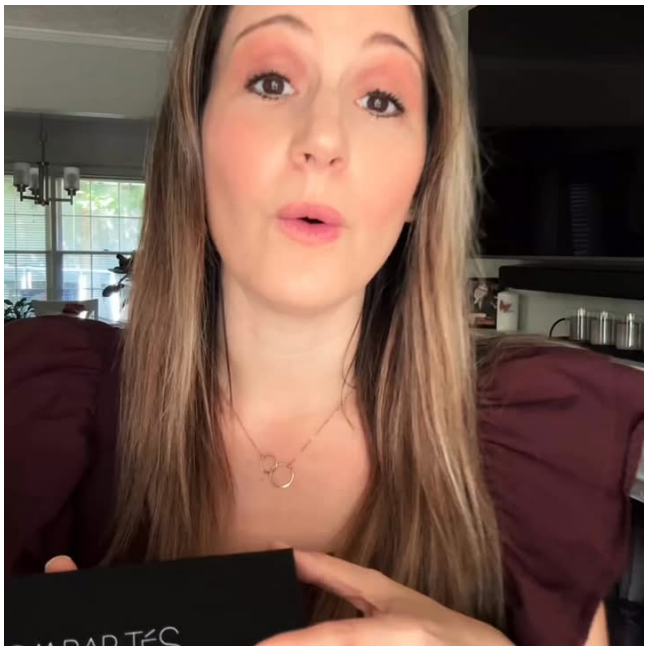
Pistachio creative: keep a proven asset working



Still image from the pistachio dynamic GIF creative. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Spend: **$11,277.32**. Meta return: **7.12x**. Click-through rate: **0.76%**. The submission says this creative first ran in June 2024 and remained useful during the 2025 holiday refresh. The lesson is practical: add new ideas while keeping an older ad that still sells. This is a still, not a playable GIF.

Evergreen compilation: give the buyer more ways to connect



Poster frame from an evergreen multi-creator video showing a chocolate gift box. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Spend: **$10,818.38**. Meta return: **5.38x**. Click-through rate: **1.13%**. Multi-creator videos brought different people and product moments into the same format. The campaign did not depend on one creator or one message.

Black Friday compilation: connect product interest to the sale



Poster frame from the Black Friday creator compilation unwrapping a chocolate bar. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Spend: **$9,466.06**. Meta return: **4.65x**. Click-through rate: **1.82%**. The planning task specifically asks for more compilation videos and holiday creator content. This is an example of that format appearing in the campaign, rather than proof that I personally edited this video.

Sale static: make the offer impossible to miss



Original Compartés sale ad offering twenty percent off chocolate bars. Original submission asset, reproduced unchanged.

Spend: **$8,220.54**. Meta return: **3.83x**. Click-through rate: **1.48%**. The ad clearly states the discount and code alongside the bars. Its return was lower than several evergreen winners. It still shows the promotional role: make the offer understandable at a glance. A clear ad is not automatically the best-returning ad.

Catalog ads: let the product set do more work

The featured catalog ad spent **$9,467.88**, returned **3.35x** and had a **2.19%** click-through rate. It has no single fixed creative image because Meta assembled the ad from the product catalog. I have kept it as a written example rather than inventing a screenshot of it.

The wider creative mix included at least seven creators, compilations, statics, GIFs, product stories and catalog treatments. Assets were prepared for square, portrait and vertical placements. The team tested new hooks, copy and formats while keeping winners in place.

Holiday creator Round 2 returned 5.79x versus 5.02x for Round 1. Closing-urgency creative returned 4.76x. A subscription test returned 4.79x and earned more budget. Those are observed campaign results, not controlled tests proving that one creative choice caused the difference.

Where AI helped me do the work

There were two kinds of AI in this story. Meta's delivery system chose who saw each eligible ad and where it appeared. My own AI use helped with the human work around that system: working through ideas, writing and refining copy, researching, analyzing results and building tools.

My job was to turn those capabilities into something the team could use. A strategist needed a useful brief, a clear next step and a reason for a budget decision. I used AI to help produce and review that work. I still had to judge whether the idea fit the product, whether the claim was supported and whether the next action made commercial sense.

That is also why I build a private marketing workspace and a personal AI brain. The marketing workspace brings account context, performance explanations, creative briefs, ad reviews and budget checks together. The brain keeps useful decisions, evidence and working rules available across projects. The goal is less repeated explanation and preparation for the people doing the work.

Those systems are ongoing projects with their own cases. I am not presenting their current features as if every one existed in November 2025. See the marketing workspace and the personal AI brain for the separate scope.

The award submission documents the campaign setup and results. My regular use of AI for creative, copy, analysis and tooling is part of my contribution. There was no test separating an AI-only effect, so I do not claim that AI alone produced the sales growth.

Black Friday: more spend, better purchase economics

This comparison uses the same weekdays around Black Friday and Cyber Monday: **November 24–December 2, 2025**, against **November 25–December 3, 2024**. Both are nine-day account-level windows.

Meta measure	2024	2025	Change
Ad spend	$33,032	$65,726	+99.0%

Meta measure	2024	2025	Change
Attributed purchase value	$135,422	$277,208	+104.7%
Attributed purchases	1,012	2,233	+120.7%
Return on ad spend	4.10x	4.22x	+2.9%
Cost per purchase	$32.64	$29.43	−9.8%
Cost per 1,000 impressions	$33.31	$22.67	−31.9%
Click-through rate	1.395%	1.508%	+8.1% relative

This was the strongest scaling result in the submission. Spend nearly doubled, purchase value grew a little faster than spend and the cost of a purchase fell. It was useful evidence that the account could take more budget during the peak without losing purchase efficiency.

The full season: more volume, with a return tradeoff

The full-season comparison is **November 1–December 31 in each year**. It answers a different question from the nine-day sale window.

Meta measure	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Ad spend	$125,927	$201,211	+59.8%
Attributed purchases	4,646	6,924	+49.0%
Attributed purchase value	$636,562	$926,640	+45.6%
Impressions	8,311,802	11,418,646	+37.4%
Click-through rate	0.980%	1.375%	+40.3% relative
Cost per click	$1.55	$1.28	−17.1%
Adds to cart	34,410	78,509	+128.2%
Cost per add to cart	$3.66	$2.56	−30.0%
Checkouts started	9,807	18,860	+92.3%
Cost per checkout	$12.84	$10.67	−16.9%

Dividing the reported purchase value by spend gives a full-season Meta return of about **5.06x in 2024 and 4.61x in 2025**. Those two values are calculated from the submission, rounded to two decimals. Overall return declined, even though purchases and sales grew. The 2025 account remained above the 4x operating threshold.

The decision was not simply to maximize the return figure. It was to grow the business within agreed spending and efficiency limits. The lower costs earlier in the shopping path were encouraging, but they did not erase the lower

full-season return per advertising dollar.

Store results and new customers

Shopify provides the total-store view. These numbers include the effect of all channels and other influences, rather than only sales attributed to Meta.

Shopify measure	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Orders	15,982	21,112	+32.1%
Total sales	$2,136,002	$2,843,922	+33.1%
Average order value	$126.23	$126.93	+0.6%
First-time customer orders	8,303	11,800	+42.1%
Returning-customer orders	7,679	9,312	+21.3%
First-time share of orders	51.95%	55.89%	+3.94 percentage points

First-time customer orders grew faster than returning-customer orders. Average order value stayed close to $127, so the growth was largely about more orders rather than a large rise in the typical order's value.

Across Meta and Google, combined spend rose 19.2%, compared with 33.1% growth in store sales. Shopify sales per combined advertising dollar increased from 7.40x to 8.26x. Combined spend as a share of Shopify sales fell from 13.52% to 12.10%.

The submission also reports combined ad spend per first-time order falling from $34.77 to $29.17. That calculation uses all first-time store orders. It is a business-level ratio, not a verified channel acquisition cost.

Cross-channel and placement decisions

The team reviewed Meta and Google together. More of the advertising budget moved toward Meta, while Google reported more conversions on less spend.

Advertising spend	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Meta	$125,926.72	$201,210.57	+59.8%
Google Ads	$162,764.26	$142,957.99	−12.2%
Combined	$288,690.98	$344,168.56	+19.2%

Google reported 28.8% more conversions. That is a separate platform result; it should not be added to Meta purchases as if both systems count sales in the same way.

Open placements also gave the team more ways to reach buyers. Instagram Stories combined meaningful spend with a strong return. Facebook Reels Overlay returned more per dollar, but on a much smaller budget.

Selected Meta placement	Reported spend	Return
Facebook Feed	$72,052	3.83x
Instagram Feed	$56,103	4.73x
Instagram Stories	$31,605	6.23x
Instagram Reels	$15,396	4.19x
Facebook Reels	$12,367	2.70x
Facebook Reels Overlay	$4,933	8.16x
Facebook Stories	$2,245	4.15x

A placement's past return is not a promise that it can absorb unlimited spend at that return. The comparison helped the team understand the mix; it did not justify putting the whole account into the smallest high-return placement.

How I read and explain the results

The submission used Meta's seven-day click and one-day view attribution setting consistently in both years. Meta measured ad delivery and attributed purchases. Shopify measured store sales, orders and customer mix. Triple Whale was used to cross-check reporting. Pixel and server-side purchase signals supported measurement; the submission reports a Purchase Event Match Quality score of 9.3.

There was no Meta Lift study or other holdout study. Agreement across reporting systems supports confidence in the reported pattern, but does not tell us how many sales would have happened without the advertising. Neither store sales per ad dollar nor platform return measures profit.

The broader published holiday case also reports +56% web sales, +81% Meta revenue, 4.26x Meta return, +34% Google return and +58% corporate gift leads. That page does not specify the exact comparison window for those headline figures. They are separate published claims, not replacements for the dated November–December tables here. I would reconcile the period before using them in the same chart.

The public evidence includes the original planning excerpts, original creative images and the campaign section of the submission. Private account exports, internal links and identity fields remain private. The figures on this page are checked against the submission and published case, not a fresh query of the 2025 accounts.

What I bring to the next team

This work connects strategy to the details that make it happen. I can turn a revenue goal into a budget plan, give creative a clear job, help strategists make account decisions and explain the results without hiding the tradeoffs. I can also use AI to build better tools around that work.

The next improvement would be to plan a lift test, clean up the small campaign-breakdown mismatch and keep the comparison window attached to every published result. Those are practical ways to make the next case easier to defend.

Read the full campaign submission · Read the original planning excerpts · Download the PDF evidence pack

Compartés: original planning excerpts

These excerpts come from two original operating tasks for the 2025 holiday season. The private source records identify me as their creator and assignee. Public copies remove people's names, internal links, contact details and unrelated notes. Formatting and line breaks are normalized. The excerpts below are source material, not a newly invented campaign plan.

Return to the main case · Read the campaign submission

Campaign update task

Created November 5, 2025. Last updated November 21, 2025. Recorded as completed. The last update precedes Black Friday. Creation and assignment fields were checked in the private original; they are omitted here to protect identity.

Increase budgets 10-20% WoW Get more compilation videos going Slot in some photography Holiday compilation UGC

The same task calls for stronger promotion of the advent calendar and a daily check of budget, spend, revenue, marketing efficiency and platform return. Those lines contain names and links in the private original, so this sentence summarizes their substance rather than presenting them as verbatim quotes.

This is evidence of my planning and direction. It does not establish that I personally filmed, designed or edited the creative, or executed every requested account change.

Holiday budget plan

Created November 7, 2025. Last updated December 15, 2025. Recorded as completed. The final notes were therefore maintained during the season. They should not all be treated as an unchanged November 7 snapshot.

Phase in the task	Dates	Planned Meta budget
Early warm-up	November 1–7	$15,000
Pre-BFCM ramp	November 8–21	$40,000
BFCM surge and extended peak	November 22–December 8	$85,000
Holiday prime	December 9–20	$45,000
Post-holiday and self-gifting	December 21–31	$15,000
Total	November–December	$200,000

The task uses the previous year's daily pattern to explain where demand was weak or strong and where to concentrate spend. It describes scaling Meta when both the overall efficiency check and a platform return above 4x support it. The separate campaign update task calls for 10–20% weekly increases.

The original rough percentage annotations do not all match the dollar amounts. This public table reproduces the planned dollars and dates, which add to $200,000. They are planning figures, not a phase-by-phase record of actual spend. Exact internal source identifiers and account links are withheld.

What these records establish

They connect my contribution to concrete work before and during the season: budgeting, timing, creative requests and the team's daily performance checks. They support the campaign story alongside the submission and actual creative. Team sales outcomes remain team outcomes; source authorship does not turn them into a solo achievement.

Compartés: the full campaign section of the award submission

Public edition of the August 2026 submission for the November 1–December 31, 2025 campaign. This is the campaign narrative and results, with contact fields, names, account identifiers, agency boilerplate, legal forms and proposed testimonials removed. Tables are reformatted. References to the season now use the exact two-month window rather than the original shorthand of eight weeks. The main case explains the work in simpler language.

Read the main case · View the original planning excerpts

Notes before reading

These are the original submission's reported figures, checked against that document rather than freshly queried from advertising accounts. Team results and platform-attributed results retain their separate meanings. The campaign table lists four selected roles whose spend totals $199,204.88, below the $201,210.57 account total by $2,005.69. Its approximate purchase values are estimates carried over from the original. The full-season return on Meta spend was about 4.61x versus about 5.06x in 2024; the improved return claim applies to the nine-day Black Friday comparison. Comparing Shopify and platform reports does not establish incremental lift.

The creative gallery in the main case reproduces the six images embedded in the submission. Video and GIF assets appear as stills. Entry administration and survey answers are omitted; the complete substantive campaign narrative follows.

Campaign Background: What problem did the Advertiser seek your Agency to solve?

Compartés is a Los Angeles chocolatier creating chocolate as art since 1950. A small team makes premium bars and gifts with bold flavor, high-quality ingredients and design-led packaging. The brand serves individual gift buyers and corporate clients. November and December are its most important sales period.

The business challenge. Holiday is the moment when Compartés' product, packaging and gifting relevance are strongest, and when every premium gift category competes hardest for the same shopper. The team needed to increase Meta investment quickly, protect purchase economics and drive orders before shipping cutoffs. The response was an account built for Meta's AI-first delivery environment, with broad audience freedom, open placements, deep creative choice and disciplined phase-based scaling.

Competitive landscape. Compartés is positioned above supermarket chocolate and with design-focused gifting brands. Packaging is a primary sales asset. Each bar has a collectible presentation.

Why Compartés engaged the team. The team manages paid social, paid search, SEO and creative strategy through one senior team. The same team can simplify Meta, coordinate channel pacing and evaluate platform results against the wider business.

Campaign Goal: What challenges did you aim to address by advertising with Meta for this specific campaign? What goals were you trying to achieve?

Primary business objective. Turn Meta into a dependable holiday growth engine. Compartés needed far more volume during its most important two months while keeping the account-level platform ROAS above the team's 4x operating threshold and checking every major budget decision against total business efficiency.

Peak-period ambition. The clearest test was Black Friday and Cyber Monday: nearly double Meta investment in the same weekday-aligned nine-day window and improve the economics at the same time. The result was 99.0% more spend, 104.7% more attributed purchase value, 120.7% more attributed purchases, 2.9% higher ROAS, 9.8% lower cost per purchase and 31.9% lower CPM.

Efficiency guardrails. The team and Compartés agreed on a platform ROAS threshold above 4x, overall business-efficiency targets and controlled 10% to 20% investment increases. This created room to scale quickly when the account could absorb more spend while protecting the commercial outcome.

Budget control. The team mapped approximately $200,000 across the season, reserved 40% to 50% for the peak window and paced each phase against the prior year's daily spend. Final Meta investment reached $201,211, within 0.6% of plan, and 40% landed in the peak period.

Measurement standard. Meta Ads Manager measured delivery and attributed purchase efficiency. Shopify measured store sales, orders, average order value and customer mix. Triple Whale cross-checked channel spend and customer outcomes. Together, the three systems showed how stronger Meta performance aligned with total-business growth.

Business outcome. Shopify recorded $2,843,922 in sales and 21,112 orders during the November–December window. First-time customer orders reached 11,800, up 42.1% year over year, while returning-customer orders grew 21.3%.

Meta product strategy. Use Advantage+ Audience, Advantage+ Placements, Advantage+ Shopping and Dynamic Product Ads as one connected growth system. Give Meta more eligible people, placements, products and creative to work with, while the team controls budget pace and commercial guardrails.

Account-wide demand creation. Purchase optimization remained the objective across Compartés' Meta account. Across evergreen, promotional, catalog and seasonal campaign roles, Holiday 2025 delivered 11,418,646 impressions, up 37.4% year over year, while CTR rose 40.3%. During the nine-day BFCM window, the account reached 896,301 people, up 163.9% year over year, as spend rose 99.0%. CPM fell 31.9%, while frequency increased only from 2.92 to 3.23. Across the full season, cost per click fell 17.1%, cost per add to cart fell 30.0% and cost per checkout fell 16.9%.

Operating discipline. Review performance against the season plan, increase budgets in measured steps and move spend only when return and purchase-cost signals support the next increase.

Campaign Approach / Solution: How did you address the challenges you faced? In what ways did you leverage Meta to achieve your campaign goals?

AI-first creative strategy. The team made creative the engine of Meta's delivery. The team continuously tested new concepts, creators, hooks, copy variations, product stories, formats and audience-specific messaging angles, then fed the strongest combinations back into broad Advantage+ delivery. Reliable purchase signals, open placements and catalog depth gave Meta room to learn, while the breadth and pace of the team's creative testing gave the system

better ads to match with each shopper.

Technical strategy. The team paired a simpler account structure with Meta's automation. That gave the platform more room to match each creative with the right shopper and placement while giving the team a clear view of where budget was working hardest. Advantage+ Audience handled approximately 87% of consumer spend, Advantage+ Placements opened the full inventory, lowest-cost bidding preserved auction flexibility, and Advantage+ Shopping with Dynamic Product Ads expanded the product and creative pool. The team kept commercial control through phase-based budgets, measured 10% to 20% increases and a 4x platform ROAS guardrail.

The account applied Meta's Performance 5 principles across five connected levers:

1. Account simplification. The team gave every campaign one clear job: always-on sales, BFCM promotion, catalog-driven product discovery or seasonal launches. This reduced overlap, kept purchase data from being scattered across too many places and made it easier to move budget toward the strongest opportunity.

2. AI-powered automation. Advantage+ Audience and broad delivery expanded the system's search space. Advantage+ Placements opened Feed, Stories, Reels and the wider inventory. Purchase optimization and lowest-cost bidding let Meta respond to demand at impression level.

3. Continuous creative testing. The team kept the account supplied with new ideas throughout the season. UGC from at least seven named creators, multi-creator compilations, holiday statics, dynamic GIFs, designed catalog ads and seasonal product stories tested distinct hooks, copy, formats and shopper motivations. Assets across all placement sizes gave Meta a deep pool of options across Feed, Stories and Reels. The team moved spend toward the strongest combinations and used each result to shape the next round of creative.

4. Signal quality. Meta Pixel and Conversions API supplied browser and server-side purchase signals, with Purchase Event Match Quality reaching 9.3. Catalog data, Shopify Audiences, purchaser exclusions, a high-LTV Klaviyo segment and selective lookalikes added first-party guidance across acquisition and retargeting.

5. Results validation. Meta Ads Manager measured attributed purchase performance, Shopify confirmed store growth and customer mix, and Triple Whale cross-checked spend and customer outcomes. The team used all three views to protect the business case as investment increased.

The system connected four commercial growth engines:

Demand capture. $121,805.49, or 60.5% of Meta spend, returned 5.29x. Broad delivery carried most of the volume, while a selective household-income and Online Shopping test with Advantage+ Placements returned 7.12x, the strongest result among scaled ad sets.

Black Friday and Cyber Monday acceleration. Against the weekday-aligned 2024 window, Meta investment rose 99.0%, purchase value rose 104.7%, purchases rose 120.7%, ROAS improved 2.9%, cost per purchase fell 9.8% and CPM fell 31.9%. A UGC compilation absorbed $9,466 at 4.65x, while closing urgency returned 4.76x.

Automated product discovery. Advantage+ Shopping spent $22,820.86 at 3.44x. Designed feed treatments carried Compartés' visual identity into catalog delivery, and Dynamic Product Ads accounted for $18,438 with 2.09% and 2.19% CTRs, the strongest format-level click-through rates in the account.

Seasonal product launches. Dedicated sales activity supported limited-edition bars and the advent calendar. Creative built around scarcity and gifting intent produced CTRs of 2.5% to 4.4% against a 1.375% account average.

Creative learning loop. Concepts launched in named batches and fixed windows. Meta could concentrate delivery around stronger ads while the team retained clean comparisons across concepts. Holiday Round 2 returned 5.79x versus 5.02x for Round 1, and Chocolate of the Month Club earned additional budget after returning 4.79x.

Human control at holiday speed. Meta's models handled person, placement and creative matching at impression level. The team controlled the commercial decisions: which concepts entered testing, when budgets increased, where spend moved and how investment responded to agreed efficiency guardrails. The season plan finished at $201,211, within 0.6% of the approximately $200,000 target.

What made the work different.

AI fluency became operating discipline. The team gave Meta's retrieval and ranking systems a larger, better-organized set of audience, product, placement and creative options, then used human judgment to govern pace and risk. During BFCM, spend rose 99.0% while ROAS improved 2.9%, cost per purchase fell 9.8% and CPM fell 31.9%.

Creative strengthened delivery. The account used varied concepts, formats and buyer cues as matching inputs for Meta's AI. UGC, statics, GIFs, catalog treatments and seasonal stories gave the system multiple routes to relevance across Feed, Stories and Reels.

Cross-source business validation. Meta-attributed purchases and purchase value rose as investment scaled. Shopify recorded 33.1% sales growth, 32.1% order growth and 42.1% growth in first-time customer orders. Triple Whale closely matched Shopify order and customer counts and Meta spend, confirming that the growth pattern held across all three reporting views.

Please specify the Meta advertising, analytics, or other Meta platform tools / products you leveraged during the campaign to help achieve your objectives.

Advantage+ Audience, Advantage+ Placements, Advantage+ Shopping Campaign, catalog and Dynamic Product Ads, Meta Pixel and Conversions API, lowest-cost bidding and Meta Ads Manager. Purchase Event Match Quality for Purchase reached 9.3.

Targeting: Who was your target audience? What Meta tools or strategies did you use to reach them?

Primary audience. US shoppers ages 18 to 65 buying premium gifts under a holiday delivery deadline. Purchase optimization allowed Meta's delivery system to identify intent from behavior, creative response, product interest and conversion signals.

Audience architecture. Advantage+ Audience covered approximately 87% of consumer spend across holiday, Black Friday, catalog and seasonal product activity. The team kept eligibility broad so Meta could use real-time purchase, product and creative-response signals without fragmenting learning across narrow audience groups.

First-party guidance. Shopify Audiences supported prospecting and retargeting alongside Existing Customers Plus, a high-LTV Klaviyo segment, a 1% purchaser lookalike and 90-day and 180-day purchaser exclusions. These inputs guided delivery while age, location and exclusion controls protected the campaign's commercial boundaries.

Selective precision. Select evergreen ad sets retained household-income signals. One combined Online Shopping with Advantage+ Placements and returned 7.12x, the strongest result among scaled ad sets. The team kept signal-led tests where account economics supported them.

Creative-driven relevance. UGC, catalog treatments, gifting scenes, offer creative and product stories carried distinct buyer cues. Those differences gave Meta's models richer creative representations and more ways to match the message to the shopper across Feed, Stories and Reels.

Audience testing. Signal-led tests ran in separate ad sets with clean spend and return visibility. Lookalike and subscription tests used the same structure, giving the team a disciplined way to challenge broad and Advantage+ delivery without fragmenting the core account.

Please include the most important point you want to highlight about your reach or targeting approach.

Approximately 87% of consumer spend ran through Advantage+ Audience. The account paired broad delivery with first-party guidance and creative-specific buyer cues, while a selective Online Shopping and household-income test returned 7.12x. This kept the core scalable and preserved a clear place for evidence-led audience tests.

Ad Placement: Which ad placements did you use for this campaign? For example, Reels, Stories, Instagram Feed, Facebook Feed, etc. Are there any specific callouts or important details about the placements that we should be aware of?

Placements used. Advantage+ Placements stayed open across Facebook and Instagram Feed, Stories, Reels, Reels Overlay, Explore, Marketplace, profile feed, in-stream video, right-hand column and notifications, plus Audience Network and Threads.

Placement performance insights.

Placement	Spend	ROAS
Facebook Feed	$72,052	3.83x
Instagram Feed	$56,103	4.73x
Instagram Stories	$31,605	6.23x
Instagram Reels	$15,396	4.19x
Facebook Reels	$12,367	2.70x
Facebook Reels Overlay	$4,933	8.16x
Facebook Stories	$2,245	4.15x

Platform split. Instagram: $103,379 at 5.12x. Facebook: $95,787 at 4.04x. Audience Network: $1,641 at 5.57x. Threads: $403 at 3.09x.

Placement creative. Assets were produced in all relevant formats. Captioned UGC worked well in Feed, Stories and Reels placements. Designed catalog treatments carried Compartés branding across placements.

Placement results. Open Advantage+ Placements gave Meta room to find efficient delivery across the full inventory. Instagram generated 5.12x on $103,379. Instagram Stories led scaled placements at 6.23x, Instagram Reels returned 4.19x and Facebook Reels Overlay reached 8.16x on $4,933. The strongest results came from a mix of feed and full-screen surfaces.

Opportunity Score: Did the advertiser implement any recommendations from the Opportunity Score? If yes, please specify which ones.

N/A

Is there anything else you'd like to share about the strategy or execution that you'd like to share?

BFCM performance. Across the nine-day peak, Meta spend rose 99.0%, attributed purchase value rose 104.7%, attributed purchases rose 120.7%, ROAS improved 2.9% and cost per purchase fell 9.8%.

Creative durability. A dynamic GIF first introduced in June 2024 remained scalable at 7.12x alongside the 2025 creative refresh. Holiday UGC Round 2 improved to 5.79x from 5.02x for Round 1, while closing-urgency creative returned 4.76x.

Testing discipline. New concepts launched in named rounds and separate windows, giving the team clean performance comparisons without disrupting evergreen winners.

Budget control. The client approved approximately $200,000 for Meta, allocated by seasonal phase using 2024 daily demand patterns, 10% to 20% budget increases and agreed efficiency thresholds. Final spend was $201,211, within 0.6% of plan. Daily pacing adjusted to live performance.

Cross-channel view. The team also manages Compartés paid search, so the team reviewed Meta and Google pacing together. Meta spend rose 59.8%. Google Ads spend fell 12.2% and reported 28.8% more conversions.

What were the results?

Measurement consistency The year-over-year analysis holds Meta's attribution settings and omni purchase definition constant. Shopify and Google Ads provide separate business and channel context.

- The primary result compares equivalent weekday-aligned BFCM windows across spend, attributed purchase value, purchases, ROAS, cost per purchase, CPM and CTR.

- Cross-source validation connected platform performance to business growth. Meta Ads Manager showed stronger attributed purchase volume and efficiency as investment scaled. Shopify recorded 33.1% sales growth, 32.1% order growth and 42.1% growth in first-time customer orders, while Triple Whale closely matched Shopify order and customer counts. The alignment across all three systems showed that the growth extended well beyond a single reporting view.

Meta performance, year over year

Metric	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Meta spend	$125,927	$201,211	+59.8%
Meta purchases	4,646	6,924	+49.0%
Meta purchase value	$636,562	$926,640	+45.6%
Impressions	8,311,802	11,418,646	+37.4%
CTR	0.980%	1.375%	+40.3%
CPC	$1.55	$1.28	−17.1%
Adds to cart	34,410	78,509	+128.2%
Cost per add to cart	$3.66	$2.56	−30.0%
Checkouts initiated	9,807	18,860	+92.3%
Cost per checkout	$12.84	$10.67	−16.9%

Across the full season, Meta investment rose 59.8%, attributed purchases grew 49.0%, attributed purchase value grew 45.6% and impressions grew 37.4%. CTR increased 40.3%, cost per click fell 17.1%, cost per add to cart fell 30.0% and cost per checkout fell 16.9%. The nine-day Black Friday window: spend nearly doubled and efficiency improved The comparison uses weekday-aligned windows so Black Friday and Cyber Monday fall in the same relative positions: 24 November to 2 December 2025 versus 25 November to 3 December 2024.

Metric	BFCM 2024	BFCM 2025	Change
Meta spend	$33,032	$65,726	+99.0%
Meta purchase value	$135,422	$277,208	+104.7%
Meta purchases	1,012	2,233	+120.7%
Meta ROAS	4.10x	4.22x	+2.9%
Cost per Meta purchase	$32.64	$29.43	−9.8%
CPM	$33.31	$22.67	−31.9%
CTR	1.395%	1.508%	+8.1%

Core performance result. During the nine-day BFCM window, Meta spend increased 99.0%. ROAS improved 2.9%, cost per purchase fell 9.8% and CPM fell 31.9%. Meta performance by campaign

Metric	Evergreen	BFCM 2025	ASC / DPA	Seasonal product	Combined
Spend	$121,805.49	$25,514.00	$22,820.86	$29,064.53	$201,210.57

Metric	Evergreen	BFCM 2025	ASC / DPA	Seasonal product	Combined
Share of spend	60.5%	12.7%	11.3%	14.4%	100%
Meta ROAS	5.29x	4.42x	3.44x	3.17x	4.61x
Purchase value	~$644,662	~$112,714	~$78,596	~$86,141	$926,640

Total-business growth, year over year

Shopify shows the wider commercial outcome: sales grew 33.1% to $2.84 million and orders grew 32.1% to 21,112. First-time customer orders grew even faster at 42.1%, moving the first-time share of orders from 51.95% to 55.89%.

Metric	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Shopify orders	15,982	21,112	+32.1%
Total sales	$2,136,002	$2,843,922	+33.1%
Average order value	$126.23	$126.93	+0.6%
First-time customer orders	8,303	11,800	+42.1%
Returning-customer orders	7,679	9,312	+21.3%
First-time share of orders	51.95%	55.89%	+3.94 pts
Meta + Google Ads spend per first-time order	$34.77	$29.17	−16.1%
Shopify sales per Meta + Google Ads dollar	7.40x	8.26x	+11.7%
Meta + Google Ads spend as % of Shopify sales	13.52%	12.10%	−1.42 pts

First-time customer orders reached 11,800 and grew twice as fast as returning-customer orders, 42.1% versus 21.3%. The first-time share of orders increased from 51.95% to 55.89%, while average order value held at approximately $127. The cross-channel reallocation

Metric	Holiday 2024	Holiday 2025	Change
Meta spend	$125,926.72	$201,210.57	+59.8%
Google Ads spend	$162,764.26	$142,957.99	−12.2%
Meta + Google Ads spend	$288,690.98	$344,168.56	+19.2%
Meta share of Meta + Google Ads spend	43.6%	58.5%	+14.8 pts

The team deliberately shifted more of the paid-media mix toward Meta. Meta's share of combined Meta and Google Ads spend rose from 43.6% to 58.5%, while Google Ads reported 28.8% more conversions on 12.2% less spend. The

reallocation expanded Meta without sacrificing paid-search productivity. Cross-channel context Meta and Google Ads together supported the season's growth while Shopify remained the source of truth for total sales. Meta absorbed more of the media mix, and Google reported more conversions on less spend. The reallocation expanded social without weakening paid-search productivity. Business impact beyond platform reporting Meta spend rose 59.8% across the season and 99.0% during BFCM. Over the same period, Shopify sales rose 33.1%, orders rose 32.1% and first-time customer orders rose 42.1%. Triple Whale closely matched Shopify order and customer counts, giving the team a consistent view of growth across platform, attribution and first-party systems. What the results show

- BFCM: Meta spend +99.0%, ROAS +2.9%, cost per purchase -9.8% and CPM -31.9%.
- Pre-purchase efficiency: cost per click -17.1%, cost per add to cart -30.0% and cost per checkout -16.9% on 59.8% more spend.
- Store growth: Shopify sales rose 33.1%, orders rose 32.1% and first-time customer orders rose 42.1%.
- Account design: consolidated commercial roles concentrated purchase learning and gave Meta's retrieval and ranking systems cleaner inputs across evergreen, promotional, catalog and seasonal activity.
- Budget control: the approximately $200,000 season plan finished at $201,211, within 0.6%.
- Customer growth: Shopify recorded 11,800 first-time customer orders, up 42.1% year over year and faster than the 21.3% growth in returning-customer orders.

How were these results measured?

- Meta Ads Manager: primary source for spend, impressions, reach, frequency, clicks, CPM, CPC, CTR, attributed purchases and attributed conversion value. Data was pulled at account, campaign, ad set, ad and placement level for both windows.
- Attribution model: 7-day click and 1-day view, applied consistently in both years. Reporting uses Meta's omni purchase metric throughout the submission.
- Shopify: primary source for orders, revenue, average order value and first-time versus returning customer mix. Reports used were Sales over time, Average order value over time, First-time versus returning customer sales and the customer cohort report. Each report covered both windows with year-over-year comparison enabled.
- Google Ads: spend and conversion data pulled directly from the Google Ads API.
- Meta Pixel and Conversions API: supported browser and server-side purchase measurement. Purchase Event Match Quality reached 9.3 for Purchase.
- Triple Whale: used as a cross-check. Primary reporting uses Shopify and platform data. Triple Whale matched Shopify orders within 0.55%, first-time orders within 0.40% and Meta spend within 0.66%.
- Comparison design. The Black Friday windows were weekday aligned. Meta attribution settings and the omni purchase definition remained constant, and Shopify reports used the same year-over-year date comparison.
- Decision framework. The team read platform efficiency and total-store growth together when deciding whether to increase budgets. That kept live optimization tied to commercial performance throughout the season.

Did you run a Meta Lift Study or other study with Meta?

No, but measurement extended beyond platform attribution through a triangulated framework across Meta Ads Manager, Shopify and Triple Whale. Meta captured attributed purchase performance, Shopify measured total-store growth, and Triple Whale aligned with Shopify order and customer counts. As Meta investment scaled, Shopify sales rose 33.1%, orders rose 32.1% and first-time customer orders rose 42.1%.

Which Meta Products did you use as part of this campaign?

Select all that apply.

- Automation: Advantage+ Audience, Advantage+ Placements and Advantage+ Shopping Campaign
- Measurement: Meta Pixel and Conversions API; Purchase Event Match Quality reached 9.3 for Purchase
- Catalog and Dynamic Product Ads: designed feed treatments carried Compartés branding
- Creative diversification: UGC from multiple creators, multi-creator compilations, holiday statics, dynamic GIFs, videos, catalog ads and seasonal product creative in placement-ready 1x1, 4x5 and 9x16 formats
- Holiday / Mega Sales Moment: Black Friday and Cyber Monday, 24 November to 2 December 2025

Which stage of the customer funnel or lifecycle does this story address?

- Full Funnel

Primary focus: acquisition. Purchase-optimized sales activity combined Advantage+ Audience, first-party guidance, creative-specific buyer cues and open placements to help Meta identify holiday demand. Always-on Advantage+ Shopping expanded product discovery, and BFCM creative accelerated conversion through the nine-day promotional peak.

Community Impact / Overall Impact: Did using Meta have a positive impact on your community or overall business (e.g., winning new business, hiring additional employees due to business growth, etc.)?

Overall business impact. The November–December window produced 21,112 Shopify orders and $2.84 million in sales. Shopify recorded 11,800 first-time customer orders, up 3,497 from the same period a year earlier.

Creator participation. The campaign used documented UGC from multiple creators. Creator content included the season's highest-spend ad and ran with statics, GIFs and catalog creative.

Operational improvement. The team and Compartés entered peak season with a repeatable growth system: clear campaign roles, a broader creative pool, measured budget increases and shared efficiency guardrails. That operating discipline helped the team finish within 0.6% of plan while nearly doubling BFCM investment and improving purchase efficiency.